minister was happy to announce that the government had cleared the raising of the second battalion. This process could take upto five years.

Most of my illustrious predecessors, barring a few like K.A.A. Raja, Mata Prasad, A. Dave and S.K. Singh, had short tenures in office and some only held additional charge. As such, there appeared to be lack of continuity and an urgent need to streamline the functioning of the Raj Bhawan. Therefore, we set about doing so in right earnest and resultantly, we evolved many new standard operating procedures (SOPs) and streamlined others. We decided to throw open the Raj Bhawan to the public once a week on Sunday. There have been a couple of thousand visitors since then. Rohini and I also decided to make the Raj Bhawan a crucible for new ideas that could make a difference to the lives of the people. Therefore we set up an organic farm with vermin compost as the manure (and banned the use of pesticides or fertilizers), a country chicken farm, bee colonies for production of honey, a small fish farm making use of a rainwater harvesting tank and a green house for an orchid nursery. We also created a lawn and terrace garden which has covered up an ugly-looking rooftop of the Durbar Hall. Florida tifdwarf grass was obtained from Chandigarh. After making a nursery to propagate the grass, the same has been used extensively to beautify other parts of the Raj Bhawan too, as also to make a pretty nine-hole golf course with the expert advice of Colonel Gurdial Singh. We also added to the guest accommodation as Itanagar does not yet have decent hotels. Two bedroom suites were constructed as an extension of the existing guest house as also a unique wooden cottage of four small bedrooms that came in a prefabricated kit, and took only a few weeks to assemble. The interiors and furnishing of these rooms of the 'Hornbill' cottage, as it has been named, were done using local materials such as cane and bamboo, the designs for which were created by Rohini. These suites could serve as benchmarks for guest rooms all over the state. Besides this, we have recently added a modern gymnasium, a badminton court, an auditorium, a children's park and store houses in the Raj Bhawan.